

Intro to Databases - Week 3

John Zimmerman

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1 Database Design - Microsoft Access Notes

1.1 Understanding the Trust Center

When opening databases of unknown origins, you may have to go through and affirm that the database file is *trustworthy*. This means that you should consider carefully inspecting any unknown database files before trusting them.

- File > Options > Trust Center > Trust Center Settings > Trusted Locations

1.2 Access Table of Contents for Objects

- Tables
- Queries
- Reports

2 Week 3 Reading - Referential Integrity

When you create a relationship between two tables, it is recommended to enforce **referential integrity**.

2.1 Conditions for Enforcing Referential Integrity

In Access, these following conditions must be met to use referential integrity:

- One of the linked fields must be a **primary key**.
- Related fields must have the same data type and field size. They must contain the same kind of information.
- Both tables must be in the same Access database.
- You cannot have a record in a related table unless a matching record already exists in the primary table.

2.2 Once You Have Established Referential Integrity

- You cannot add a record in a related table unless a matching record already exists in the primary table
- You cannot change the value of a primary key in the primary table if matching records exist in the related table.
- You cannot delete a record from a primary table if matching records exist in a related table.

2.3 Cascade Options

To ensure changes are made between connected fields, the **Cascade Update Related Fields** option automatically updates the corresponding fields. To ensure that when you delete a record in the main table, click the **Cascade Delete Related Records** box.